

Chapter 160-4

After watching this dance, Liang Shi found that the fan movements involved were all relatively simple.

But dancing with props and dancing without props were completely different. To avoid dragging everyone else down, she still needed to practice her part thoroughly with the fan.

However, there were no fans at Zhao Xuning's place, so Liang Shi messaged Zhao Xuning: 【Can you bring back a fan when you come home?】

Zhao Xuning: 【...Your room has air conditioning. The remote is in the bedside drawer.】

Liang Shi: 【No, I need a fan for practicing martial arts.】

Zhao Xuning: 【?】

Liang Shi: 【Correction: dance.】

Zhao Xuning: 【??】

When Zhao Xuning came back, she had still bought a fan, then stood at the doorway of the room staring at Liang Shi.

Her stare made Liang Shi feel a bit embarrassed, and she couldn't quite continue practicing her dance.

"Go do your own thing, don't worry about me," Liang Shi said.

Zhao Xuning said: "I'm just watching."

"What's there to watch? You'll be able to see it on TV later anyway," Liang Shi said.

Zhao Xuning stared at her abdomen, and after a long while said in a seemingly indifferent tone: "You actually have abs."

Liang Shi: "....."

She answered matter-of-factly: "What else would I have?"

Zhao Xuning: "....."

"I do two hundred crunches every day," Liang Shi said. "Besides, I make a living off my face and figure. If an actress can't keep up physically, she'll be at a disadvantage when delivering lines."

Zhao Xuning: "....."

"I understand now." Zhao Xuning sneered. "You drag me to eat late-night snacks every day while secretly doing crunches yourself."

Liang Shi: "?"

Why did that sound so much like—"You cunning, treacherous villain"?

"No, listen to my explanation," Liang Shi said. "Eating is eating, but I really don't gain weight, right? As for doing crunches, that's my exercise habit. The abs are just something I casually developed."

Zhao Xuning: ".....Okay, got it."

Her face still had that expression of—"Go ahead and make things up, I'll just quietly watch you make things up."

Liang Shi felt she couldn't explain herself clearly, but Zhao Xuning didn't plan to keep watching either. She went back to her room, changed into workout clothes, and headed straight out the door.

Liang Shi leaned against the doorframe and asked: "Where are you going?"

Zhao Xuning didn't even turn her head: "The gym."

Liang Shi: "....."

Top students probably just couldn't stand losing at anything?

Liang Shi didn't understand, but she got it.

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The variety show Liang Shi was participating in was called "Happy Tropic"¹. The others performing with her were all from girl groups, all with idol faces.

Liang Shi stood out a bit among them.

However, she barely managed to keep up during the first run-through, and even her fan spinning was quite beautiful.

But anyone who could sign with Huayi wasn't bad.

During a break, she sat there by herself spinning the fan for fun, and the dance director saw her. He thought one of her movements was particularly beautiful and wanted to temporarily add it to the dance.

After changing that one, the dance director brought back the difficulty level he had previously reduced out of fear it was too high.

There was one move where you throw the fan high in the air, spin 360 degrees on the spot, then flick your sleeve and catch the fan backhanded. It would fit perfectly with a line in the song they were performing.

Originally this move was included, but because the difficulty was too high and none of these people were professional dancers, they had to abandon it.

But when done well, this move was especially impressive.

Now, after seeing Liang Shi, the dance director's hopes were reignited. He explained the key points of the move to Liang Shi and had her try it. On the first try, the fan fell to the ground, but on the second try, she could spin beautifully and catch the fan steadily.

Truly gifted.

The dance director wanted to temporarily adjust the positions, but Liang Shi deeply understood the implications and didn't agree.

She said quietly to the dance director: "The original focus of this dance is meant to highlight the three of them. This is their stage. It wouldn't be good for me to steal the spotlight like this. Besides, if the dance is too eye-catching, it will distract everyone's attention from the song, reducing what was originally a beautiful piece of music to mere background music. That's not good."

Hearing this, the dance director had no choice but to give up.

When rehearsal ended and everyone was about to go home, the group's leader said to Liang Shi: "You're amazing."

"Huh?" Liang Shi was surprised. "I just did what I was supposed to do."

"But that's already remarkable," the leader said. "Being able to step back for the sake of the work in front of a big stage is very admirable."

Liang Shi chuckled softly at this: "I guess that's an occupational habit of actors?"

The recording naturally went smoothly.

Although Liang Shi was a peripheral figure, her movements were fluid, her voice was pleasant, and especially in the red outfit, she was exceptionally stunning.

She especially had a certain quality about her.

The others were singing, while she was acting along with the lyrics.

Every look in her eyes was just right.

After their performance, the host said this was her "red outfit kill"² and was curious whether she could achieve the same red outfit effect no matter what she wore.

Liang Shi smiled and said: "Depends on the situation."

When she finally changed back into casual clothes, it felt like she had become a completely different person.

In any case, her first variety show recording went rather smoothly.

This episode would air next Friday evening, and it was a satellite TV variety show³.

Afterward, it would be simultaneously broadcast on the four major online platforms.

After finishing the variety show recording, Liang Shi went back to the company with the girl group. In the car, she listened to them chatting about the upheaval in upper management.

One of the girls said: "It's got nothing to do with me anyway. It's not like I'll ever meet the CEO."

Another said: "I heard the new CEO is a particularly beautiful female Alpha. An employee saw her come to the company—she's at the level where she could be pulled out as an artist and it wouldn't seem out of place."

"That good-looking?"

"Yeah."

"When is she coming again? I'll pretend to run into her by chance."

"You'd have better luck dreaming about it. I heard the contract has already been signed, and it's been her assistant coming all the times after that."

"What a shame. I was hoping to dream about becoming the CEO's wife."

"....."

They chatted for a while longer before shifting the topic to recently released dramas.

Liang Shi sat in the back row unable to join the conversation, nor did she have the mind to join in. She lowered her head and played mobile games on her phone.

Footnotes:

¹ **"Happy Tropic" (開心回歸線):** The show's name literally translates to "Happy Tropic/Return Line." "回歸線" refers to the Tropic of Cancer or Tropic of Capricorn in geography, but here it's used as part of a variety show name suggesting happiness and return/reunion.

² **"Red outfit kill" (紅衣殺):** Internet slang where "kill" (殺) is used to describe a look or moment that is so stunning it metaphorically "kills" (captivates/slays) the audience. "Red outfit kill" means looking devastatingly attractive in red clothing.

³ **Satellite TV variety show (衛視上星綜藝):** "上星" refers to programs that are broadcast via satellite, meaning they can be received nationwide rather than just locally. This indicates the show has significant reach and prestige.